

RESTORATIVE

# Root Canal Therapy

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## BEFORE YOUR APPOINTMENT

- Eat a good meal beforehand, as you'll be numb for a few hours afterward.
- Take any prescribed antibiotic as directed before the appointment.
- Plan for a normal day afterward — most patients return to regular activity right away.

## AFTER YOUR TREATMENT

### Careful — You're Numb

Don't chew anything until the anesthetic wears off. Gum tissue at the injection site may be sore for 24–48 hours.

### Expected Soreness

The tooth may feel tender for several days to a week, particularly if there was pain or infection beforehand. Over-the-counter ibuprofen usually manages it well.

### Protect the Tooth

Do not chew on the treated tooth until the permanent crown or filling is placed. A root-canal-treated tooth is brittle and can fracture without full coverage.

### Rinsing

Rinse with warm salt water after meals to soothe the gum tissue.

### Medications

If antibiotics were prescribed, finish the full course even once you feel better.

### Call Us If

Pain increases instead of decreasing, swelling develops, the temporary filling comes out, or your bite feels uneven.